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ATTRACTION: Dungeshwari Hill Cave

ALTERNATIVE NAMES:

Pragbodhi Mountain

LOCATION:

Dungeshwari Hills, near Bodhgaya

DISTRICT / REGION:

Gaya

CATEGORY:

Religious Site / Cave Temple

OVERVIEW:

Dungeshwari Hill Cave, also known as Pragbodhi Mountain, is a deeply revered pilgrimage site in the Gaya district. It is the sacred location where Gautama Buddha is believed to have meditated for a long period before moving to Bodhgaya to attain enlightenment. The site features multiple cave temples enshrining statues of Buddha and a Hindu goddess.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION:

The Dungeshwari Hill Cave comprises several cave temples connected by a concreted walkway. Inside one of the cave temples, a striking golden bony Buddha statue is enshrined, symbolizing his severe asceticism before enlightenment. In another cave, a tall statue of the Buddha is placed. Additionally, a Hindu goddess, Dungeshwari, is enshrined inside the cave temple, showcasing the site's spiritual importance for both Buddhists and Hindus.

HISTORICAL OR CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE:

This mountain is known historically as Pragbodhi (meaning "prior to enlightenment") because it represents the crucial phase of extreme austerity and meditation Gautama underwent just before he journeyed to Bodhgaya to achieve enlightenment under the Bodhi Tree.

LEGENDS, STORIES, OR TRADITIONS:

It is a widespread belief that Gautama meditated in these very caves for a long period, practicing extreme asceticism, which is depicted by the bony golden statue enshrined here.

KEY HIGHLIGHTS:

- Golden bony Buddha statue.
- Tall Buddha statue in an adjacent cave.
- Shrine of Hindu Goddess Dungeshwari.
- Concreted walkway leading to the temples.

VISITOR INFORMATION:

Best Time To Visit:

Not Mentioned

Opening Hours:

Not Mentioned

Entry Fee:

Not Mentioned

Duration Recommended:

Not Mentioned

Photography:

Not Mentioned

Accessibility Information:

A concreted walkway leads to the temples.

FACILITIES:

Not Mentioned

TRANSPORTATION:

Nearest Airport:

Gaya Airport

Distance From Airport:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Railway Station:

Gaya Railway Station

Distance From Railway Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Distance From Bus Stand:

Not Mentioned

Road Connectivity:

Gaya is well connected by road. Bus and Taxi Services can be used to reach here.

Nearest Tourist Information Centre:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Police Station:

Not Mentioned

Nearest Medical Facility:

Not Mentioned

NEARBY ATTRACTIONS:

- Bodhgaya
- Brahmayoni Hills

FESTIVALS AND EVENTS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL CULTURE AND EXPERIENCES:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL FOOD AND CUISINE:

Not Mentioned

SHOPPING AND SOUVENIRS:

Not Mentioned

ACCOMMODATION:

Not Mentioned

HOTELS:

Not Mentioned

LOCAL GUIDES:

Not Mentioned

TRAVEL OPERATORS:

Not Mentioned

IMPORTANT FACTS:

- Also known as Pragbodhi Mountain.
- Contains a golden bony statue depicting Buddha's ascetic phase.

RETRIEVAL SUMMARY:

Dungeshwari Hill Cave (Pragbodhi Mountain) in Gaya is a sacred site where Gautama Buddha meditated before attaining enlightenment in Bodhgaya. Accessible via a concreted walkway, the caves house a golden bony Buddha statue, a tall Buddha statue, and a shrine to the Hindu Goddess Dungeshwari. It is accessible from Gaya Airport and Railway Station.

QUESTION-ANSWER FACTS:

Q: What is this attraction known for?

A: It is known as the place where Buddha meditated extensively before moving to Bodhgaya for enlightenment.

Q: Where is it located?

A: It is located in the Dungeshwari Hills in Gaya.

Q: What statues are inside the caves?

A: The caves house a golden bony Buddha statue, a tall Buddha statue, and a statue of the Hindu goddess Dungeshwari.

Q: How can visitors reach it?

A: Visitors can arrive via Gaya Airport and Gaya Railway Station, with a concreted walkway leading up to the temples.

KEYWORDS:

Dungeshwari Hill Cave, Pragbodhi Mountain, Gaya, Bodhgaya, Buddha Meditation, Golden Bony Buddha Statue, Goddess Dungeshwari, Asceticism, Buddhist Circuit.

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